

Plan coverage and metal levels

Essential health benefits

Individual Exchange health insurance plans are required to cover essential health benefits or essential care and services as defined by each state. To learn more about essential health benefits, go to [healthcare.gov](https://www.healthcare.gov).

Metal level plans

Plans offered on the Exchange are grouped into 4 metal levels based on the actuarial value: Bronze, Silver, Gold and Platinum. Each level covers the same set of essential health benefits but differs by how much the member pays in premium and total cost-share. UnitedHealthcare offers Bronze, Silver and Gold plans. We do not offer Platinum plans.

	Bronze	Silver	Gold	Platinum
Monthly premium	\$	\$\$	\$\$\$	\$\$\$\$
Cost per visit/ prescription	\$\$\$\$	\$\$\$	\$\$	\$
Plan pays*	60%	70%	80%	90%
Member pays*	40%	30%	20%	10%

* These percentages represent overall average cost-sharing across all covered services and members – not per visit or prescription. To learn more about specific plan types, reference [UnitedHealthcare benefits plans for Individual Exchanges](#).

Identifying metal levels

The ID card will identify the metal level and plan name. See the [Health plan ID card](#) section of this chapter.

Premium tax credits and cost-sharing reduction subsidies

People who purchase coverage on the Individual Exchange may qualify for financial assistance to help lower their premium or cost-share amounts depending on their household income. As a member's qualifications change, so does eligibility for financial assistance or other government programs like Medicaid. These changes can occur within the same calendar year. Individuals must inform their state Exchange when financial changes occur, so the government can adjust their subsidy accordingly. You should verify eligibility at the point of service to confirm coverage and benefits.

3-month grace period

Individual Exchange members will have a premium they are responsible to pay each month to maintain coverage. The Patient Protection and Affordable Care Act (ACA) requires health insurers to provide a 3-month grace period before terminating coverage for people who have not paid their premium. The grace period applies to those who receive an advanced premium tax credit and have paid at least 1 full month's premium within the benefit year. Members are required to pay the first month's premium before coverage goes into effect. Additionally, for individuals who do not receive federal subsidy assistance, plans are required to provide a grace period consistent with state law (typically 30 or 31 days) before terminating coverage.

How the 3-month grace period works*

Month 1	UnitedHealthcare processes the claims.
Month 2	UnitedHealthcare pends the claims and sends a letter to the health care provider advising them of the delinquency. The member receives a copy of the letter. You may not balance bill the member at this time. Reminders are sent to the member to complete payment.
Month 3	UnitedHealthcare pends the claims and sends a letter to the health care provider advising of the delinquency. The member receives a copy of the letter. You may not balance bill the member at this time. If the premium is paid in full by the end of the grace period, claims are released. OR If the premium is not paid in full by the end of the grace period, the member's coverage will terminate to the end of the first month. Any claims received during the second and third month will be processed and denied. You may bill the member for any unpaid amounts at the end of the grace period.

* Certain states (Texas) may require payers to pay all claims during the grace period. If a member does not pay their premium after the grace period has expired, coverage is terminated retrospectively and previously paid claims will be recouped.

Identifying members in a grace period

There are 3 ways to verify if the member is in a grace period:

1. EDI 271 Response Transactions – we return the following information:

- Coverage Status
 - First month: Active
 - Second month: Active – Pending Investigation
 - Third month: Active – Pending Investigation
- Period Start – First day of the first month of the grace period
- Period End – Last day of the third month of the grace period
- MSG – Individual Exchange grace period



If the service date is 1 month after the claim-eligible through date, the member is in the second grace period month.

2. API

Our Application Programming Interface solution will return a grace period message, the grace period month and period end.

3. UnitedHealthcare Provider Portal

The online secure UnitedHealthcare Provider Portal will indicate if the member is within a grace period and at what month. The portal also includes an informational icon message over which the user can hover to understand what each period means to them and the member. If additional assistance is needed, you will be able to chat with a provider advocate from within the UnitedHealthcare Provider Portal.

4. Contact Us

Verify member eligibility by connecting with us 24/7 from the [UnitedHealthcare Provider Portal](#). For chat options and contact information, visit UHCprovider.com/contactus.

UnitedHealthcare benefit plans for Individual Exchanges

Plans are grouped into 5 product families

Plan name	Highlights	Plan metal level
Required* Predictable structure	- Available in all states where we offer Individual Exchange plans - Plan design and cost-shares government mandated	Bronze, Silver and Gold plans
Essential* Basic coverage	- Lowest premiums - High-deductible/high out-of-pocket - No coinsurance, deductible only	Bronze plans
Value* Balance of cost vs. coverage	- Lower premiums - Moderate deductibles - Mix of copay and coinsurance - Some pre-deductible coverage	Bronze, Silver and Gold plans
Copay Focus* Easy to understand and predictable out-of-pocket costs	\$0 medical deductible - Copays for most services - Price transparency through more predictable copays	Bronze, Silver and Gold plans
Advantage* Lower upfront costs at point of care	- Higher premiums - Lower deductibles - Copays for many services	Silver and Gold plans

* A "*" sign indicates plan includes embedded adult dental and vision coverage and a "-" sign indicates no pediatric dental coverage.